MONTHLY UPDATE

Tanzania: monthly update, September – October 2026

Edition of 2026-10-12 · compiled by Claude Opus from the documents in the Corpus repository

> *Developments summarised from sources published between the beginning of last month and today.*

SUMMARY OF THE MONTH · GOVERNANCE · FINANCE · ICT INFRASTRUCTURE · DPI · DIGITALISATION · TECHNOLOGY · CAPACITY · INCLUSION · DATA

Summary of the month

The government presented a digital infrastructure investment envelope of US$2.6bn to 2031 to European investors in Helsinki on 28 September. The ICT Commission said a National AI Strategic Framework 2026-2031 is awaiting approval. The Citizen Budget published on 22 September raises the digital service tax on foreign providers to 3% for 2026/27. The Dar es Salaam internet exchange upgraded its core to 100G on 23 September, and the competition regulator is reviewing a Kenyan bank's purchase of a 22.23% stake in a payments firm.

Governance

Legislation and regulation

The Citizen Budget 2026/27, published on 22 September, lists the digital service tax on foreign digital service providers as raised from 2% to 3%. Its effective date and statutory clause are not stated.

A legal update drew attention to regulations in force since 1 July 2026 that make proof of a digital payment facility, such as Lipa Namba or TANQR, a condition of every new or renewed business licence; the Government Notice was published on 30 June 2026.

Data protection

The community development ministry told parliament on 31 August 2026 that a National Advisory Committee on Online Child Protection and Safety has been established and that an online-safety education campaign had reached 1,811,212 children across all 26 mainland regions. The data protection commission reported 15,146 institutions registered with it and 445 personal-data complaints received by August 2026.

Standards

Zanzibar's government told its House of Representatives on 9 September that a guideline on shared fibre poles and a single fibre contractor is being prepared, after each provider erected its own.

Public debate and participation in policymaking

An activist and social-media influencer filed a complaint against a platform company in a California court on 21 August 2026, alleging that her accounts were disabled at the direction of the government.

Finance

Domestic budget appropriations and expenditure

The identity system acquired a stated development allocation. At the Identity Day observance the Prime Minister put more than 132bn/- to the registration authority's development projects for 2026/27, including 31 registration offices, in the same speech in which he said the government cannot keep absorbing the cost of printing high-cost cards that are then abandoned. The figure comes from a speech rather than an appropriation document, and no prior-year allocation is held to read it against.

MoUs and other agreements

A Korean track was pressed at the Korea-Africa economic cooperation ministerial, where the finance minister agreed to accelerate delivery of a stated US$2.5bn Korean commitment covering transport infrastructure, technology, culture, industry and health, and a university partnership was pressed on artificial intelligence, digital skills, research and technology entrepreneurship. Neither carries a signed instrument, a digital allocation or a date.

New investments

The Fair Competition Commission opened a review on 21 August of a Kenyan bank's acquisition of 22.23% of the payments company Pesapal, which gives it indirect control of Pesapal's Tanzanian subsidiary, a payment service provider licensed by the Bank of Tanzania. Public comment closed on 4 September; the price is undisclosed and no decision is on record.

At the EU-Tanzania investment forum in Helsinki on 28 September the government presented TZS 7,000bn of digital infrastructure investment to 2031, still to be mobilised, covering fibre-to-the-premises, the Kilimanjaro One submarine cable, device manufacture, a technology park and smart classrooms. No financier or split between public and private money is published.

ICT Infrastructure

Connectivity

The month's other route is a border crossing that has not begun. The foreign minister said the two countries would fast-track a national fibre-optic cable from Kigoma to Kalemie in the Democratic Republic of Congo through Lake Tanganyika, alongside a standard gauge railway link through Burundi and a joint economic commission. No route survey, cost, financing, landing point or delivery date is published.

The regulator scored quality for the quarter to June 2026: the state operator highest at 98.1%, ahead of the largest operator at 97.7% and the third at 97.1% — the state operator leading on quality while holding a small share of the market. The measurement's components and the underlying market shares are not stated. The state operator agreed with the Burundian backbone operator to raise cross-border capacity from 4Gbps to 10Gbps, reported 9 September.

The service providers' association upgraded the Dar es Salaam exchange's core switching to 100G on 23 September; the exchange connects 66 networks and averaged about 205 Gbps in late September against about 110 Gbps a year earlier, on its own statistics. The regulator's director general put available international capacity at 17,690 Gbps, of which 2,731 Gbps, or 15.4%, was in use in June 2026.

The same presentation put smartphone penetration at 44.74% in June 2026, against the regulator's 42.5% for March; no user count accompanies it.

Data Storage

Zanzibar's communications minister said more than TZS 53bn is set aside for three ICT infrastructure projects, chiefly a data centre and public internet.

Cybersecurity

August gave the national series the earlier account lacked. The regulator's director general later set the June 2026 count against 23,328 reported cases in September 2023, a 69% fall, and said awareness campaigns may have raised reporting.

DPI

Data Exchange

The health ministry described cutting the number of health systems, linking private and public ones, and preparing a national Health Data Centre as a single access point for research and trials; no access rule beyond user role is published. The central bank signed a cooperation agreement with IFC on the credit reporting system.

The deputy communications minister called on parcel and express courier providers to register and connect their tracking systems to the national tracking and information-exchange systems, commending those already linking to the Communication Monitoring System the regulator oversees.

Digital Identity and CRVS

Where the checks run became the point. The central bank backed a credit bureau's locally hosted fraud detection, anti-money-laundering screening and know-your-customer verification for Tanzanian lenders, the local operation being what is claimed for it. No directive, licence, hosting requirement or supervisory condition is held.

On 16 September the Prime Minister directed the identity authority to drop the age bar and register young children, and the authority restated its plan to carry birth certificates, health insurance and the passport on the national ID; no start date is set.

On International Identity Day the registration authority said it will link the national identity to nine services, up from four, naming birth certificates, health insurance, the taxpayer number, driving licences and blood group. It gave no timetable.

The home affairs minister said 6,308 identity cards printed for Zanzibar residents remained uncollected, and that government was considering fines for late collection.

Digital Payments and Fintech

The state operator took its card into a stadium. The African Development Bank and AXIAN launched a digital finance programme on 2 September targeting 34,000 women-led businesses in Madagascar, Tanzania and Senegal through the Mixx and MVola platforms, under a US$160 million senior corporate loan approved to the group in January 2025 with a US$2.5 million grant for financial literacy and credit access. The Tanzanian channel is the Mixx group savings service run with a local bank, which the same account puts at more than 68,000 registered members and 16,000 savings groups by December 2024; no target, enrolment or disbursement figure is published for the country. A bank and the Zanzibar health fund signed a memorandum on member enrolment and contribution collection.

Registries

The lands ministry inspected a National Land Data Infrastructure project building a central land database and access platform on new aerial imagery, with no financier, cost or completion date stated.

Sectoral management information systems

Community health work is being tied to the payment rail. Local government's ICT director said a blueprint exists for community health worker systems, with a joint dashboard to track services and payments, built by local experts; the blueprint itself is not published.

The planning ministry presented e-Delivery as the system that will track every state development project from planning through funding to execution, with fund releases matched to what it records. No coverage figure or start date is given. The Prime Minister's Office said its Persons with Disabilities Management Information System is connected to 11 government systems and issues a reference number to students applying for higher-education loans; no count of people registered is stated.

A development partner said its tool mapping disability care and support services, piloted in Unguja, has been integrated into Zanzibar's Jumuishi management information system; no integration date is stated.

Other GovTech and e-Gov

Zanzibar's automated road cameras reached the House of Representatives, members calling the 50 km/h limit too low and the Sh230,000 fine too high and asking why government vehicles go unpenalised.

The same board approved an emerging technologies governance framework for public institutions on 31 August, setting principles, roles and risk and impact duties for AI, blockchain, the internet of things and other technologies before an institution adopts them.

Digitalisation

Digitalisation of sub-national government

The mandatory project-records system produced a throughput figure for the first time: 150 development projects registered since its launch on 1 July 2026, against a target of more than 500, with the planning commission pressing ministries' policy and planning directors to register faster, the platform being the instrument through which the 2050 development vision is to be implemented. No deadline attaches to the 500 target, no list of registered projects is published, and nothing states what registration obliges an institution to do.

Technology

AI

The only movement on machine-generated content is in the argument rather than the rule. Technology, academic and creative voices backed digital watermarking of machine-generated content as a way to restore accountability and discourage over-reliance on the tools, following the European transparency duties that took effect on 2 August 2026. No domestic proposal, consultation or instrument follows from it, against online content rules that already prohibit such content outright.

A month later the rules existed. On 31 August the e-Government Authority's board approved standards and guidelines for AI in public institutions, binding every institution and every AI system it runs, requiring impact and risk assessments and prohibiting fully automated decisions with significant outcomes. They are a standard under the e-government statute, not a law, and the national strategy text is still not public.

On a study visit to Helsinki reported on 29 September, the ICT Commission's head of ICT development said the National AI Strategic Framework 2026-2031 is awaiting approval, and that the commission proposes a national readiness and compute-demand assessment feeding a planned AI observatory. No text of the framework is published. The state power utility launched an AI-powered customer channel and a portal for large customers.

ICT Industry

The sector has multiplied and says it cannot scale. A United Nations capital development fund counts 171 active fintech companies in 2026 against 33 in 2021, alongside more than 70 per cent of adults holding a mobile money account and 6.4 billion digital payment transactions in 2024, and founders told a Dar es Salaam session that partnerships with banks and mobile operators remain the main barrier - banks assessing early-stage firms through a static lens, the core processing layer commoditised as institutions build in house, limited patient capital, talent shortages, regulatory and tax uncertainty and the cost of acquiring customers. The stated ambition is to be a leading African fintech market by 2031, with no intermediate target on file.

One account of the trading economy the fintech count sits above reached the repository: an e-commerce sector that runs on an Instagram storefront, a WhatsApp sales desk, a mobile-money rail, a motorcycle courier for the last mile and long-distance buses across the border, rather than on platforms with catalogues and checkout. It is a reported description rather than a measurement, and the repository holds no transaction volume, merchant count or dispute mechanism for any part of it.

Innovation ecosystem

A private channel opened alongside the state ventures programme. The leading mobile operator entered a three-year partnership with a global entrepreneurship network to reach 1,000 entrepreneurs and 40 ventures, with a first cohort of entrepreneur-support organisations due in October 2026. No commitment amount is stated, so what exists is a set of targets with no measurable resource behind them.

A UN programme put TZS 1.3bn into a fifth cohort of 14 businesses at Innovation Week and launched a platform matching innovators with investors, reporting over US$3m to innovators since 2021 on its own count.

A Belgian-run programme covering Tanzania, Uganda and Senegal for 2026-2028 tendered a women-in-tech community platform and the sourcing of 12 African and European ventures on 21 September, bids closing 23 October; no budget is stated. The ICT ministry launched a TZS 5 billion loan programme for youth-owned ICT start-ups on 2 October, run with a commercial bank in three tiers up to TZS 100 million. Zanzibar's communications minister said a draft startups bill creating a fund of grants and low-cost loans is due for first reading in November or December 2026.

Capacity

Literacy

The national service said on 18 September that its patriotism and digital patriotism subjects will continue to be improved, for an intake that began on 8 September. No curriculum text, hours or recruit count is held.

Training and skills

The instrument behind teacher training entered the repository, and it is eleven years old. Delivery against the revision moved in the window — government secondary school teachers took a four-day programme in Arusha from 1 to 4 September covering 10 of the revised standards' 15 modules, under a third phase funded through a Korean

funds-in-trust arrangement — which is the first time the repository can see modules being delivered rather than a training count. Fifteen modules against the held text's six is the gap the unpublished revision would close, and no teacher-reach figure is published against the target the digital economy framework carries.

Inclusion

Access to services

Mobile-industry research found identity requirements for SIM registration leave refugee women registering lines through local citizens or intermediaries. The communications regulator reported at a regional cohort meeting of 5 to 9 October 2026 that its initiative on assistive technologies for persons with disabilities was 80 percent complete, its website accessibility work recognised under a new national standard on accessibility of ICT products and services.

Digital divides

The universal service fund said it will build 250 ICT laboratories of 20 computers each in public schools this financial year, where it had supplied about five computers a school.

Data

Open data

A mapping organisation working with government began handing ward flood preparedness plans to communities in five Dar es Salaam wards from 14 September 2026, built on mapping and community participation under an externally funded project.

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